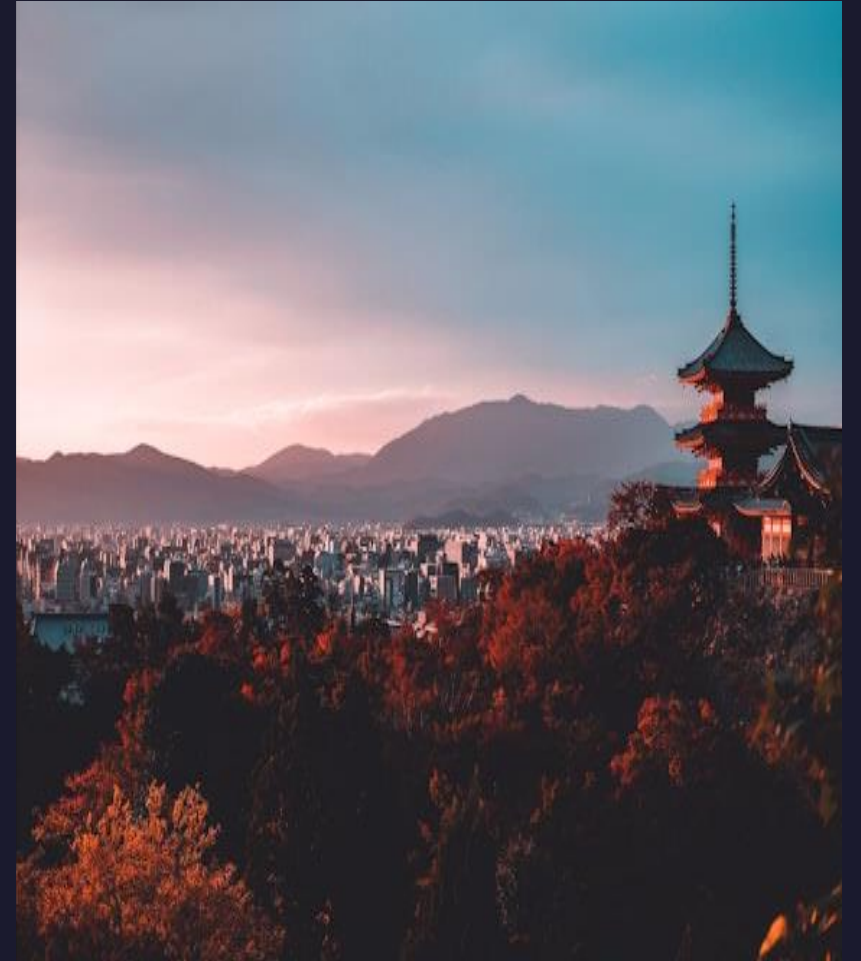


Jainism and Buddhism

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Grade: 9A

A 9th-Grade History Project



Historical Context

6th Century BCE India

- The 6th century BCE was a period of intense spiritual and intellectual ferment in ancient India.
- The Gangetic plain saw the rise of 16 Mahajanapadas (great kingdoms) competing for power.
- Vedic religion, dominated by elaborate rituals and priestly authority, was increasingly questioned.
- Shramana movements (wandering ascetics) challenged Brahminical orthodoxy by emphasizing personal effort over ritual sacrifice.
- Both Jainism and Buddhism emerged as reformist responses to social inequality, caste rigidity, and ritualistic excess.
- The period coincided with other Axial Age philosophers: Confucius in China, Socrates in Greece, and Zoroaster in Persia.



Life of Vardhamana Mahavira

599–527 BCE | The Great Hero of Jainism

- Born c. 599 BCE in Vaishali (modern Bihar) into the Kshatriya clan of the Licchavi republic.
- His parents were followers of Parshvanatha, the 23rd Tirthankara — Mahavira became the 24th and last.
- At age 30 he renounced his royal life, discarded clothing, and began 12 years of intense ascetic practice.
- He achieved Kevala Jnana (omniscience / enlightenment) after meditating under a Sala tree near Jrimbhikagrama.
- He then preached for 30 years, establishing the four-fold Jain community: monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen.
- He attained moksha (liberation) at Pavapuri, Bihar, at the age of 72.



Core Philosophy of Jainism

Triratna (Three Jewels) & Ahimsa (Non-Violence)

Triratna — the Three Jewels of Jainism:

1. Samyak Darshana (Right Faith): Belief in the teachings of the Tirthankaras.
 2. Samyak Jnana (Right Knowledge): Correct understanding of the soul and the universe.
 3. Samyak Charitra (Right Conduct): Living ethically through the Five Vows (Pancha Mahavrata).
- Ahimsa (Non-Violence): The supreme ethical principle — avoiding harm to all living beings, including insects and microorganisms.
 - Anekantavada: The doctrine of many-sidedness — truth is complex and must be seen from multiple perspectives.
 - Karma in Jainism is conceived as a physical substance that clings to the soul; liberation requires purging all karmic matter.



Sects of Jainism

Digambara (Sky-clad) & Svetambara (White-clad)

- The two main sects split around 300 BCE, primarily over monastic practice and scripture.

Digambara ('sky-clad'):

- Monks practice complete nudity as a symbol of total renunciation.
- Believe women cannot attain moksha in a female body.
- Reject the canonical Agamas as authentic; rely on secondary texts.
- Predominant in Karnataka and parts of Maharashtra.

Svetambara ('white-clad'):

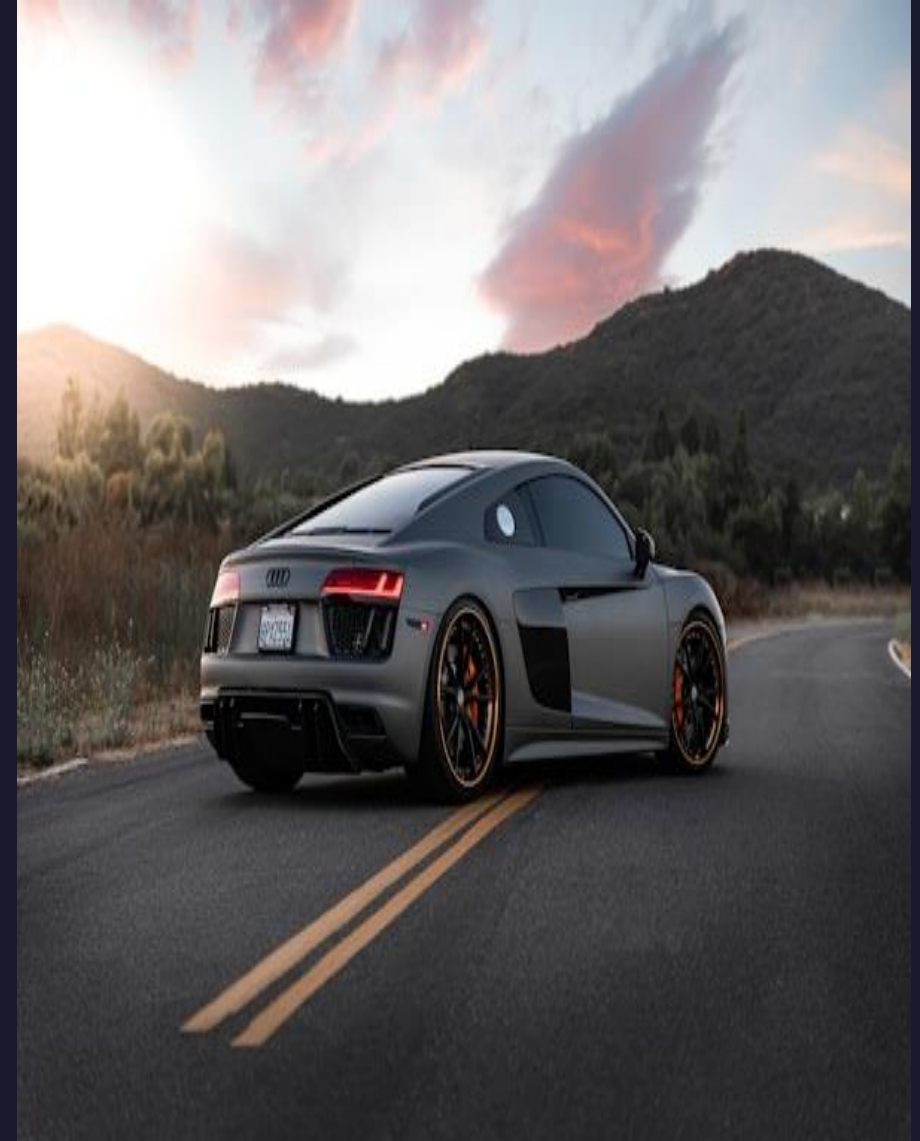
- Monks and nuns wear simple white garments.
- Accept women as capable of achieving moksha.
- Accept the 45 Agamas as authentic scripture.
- Predominant in Gujarat and Rajasthan.



Life of Siddhartha Gautama

c. 563–483 BCE | From Prince to Enlightened One

- Born c. 563 BCE in Lumbini (modern Nepal) to King Suddhodana of the Shakya clan.
- Raised in luxury within three palaces; sheltered from suffering by his father.
- At 29, he encountered the 'Four Sights': an old man, a sick man, a corpse, and a wandering ascetic.
- He renounced his palace, wife, and son Rahula — an event called the 'Great Renunciation' (Mahabhinishkramana).
- After six years of asceticism and study under various teachers, he rejected extreme self-mortification.
- He attained Enlightenment (Bodhi) meditating under a Bodhi tree in Bodh Gaya, Bihar.
- He delivered his first sermon at Sarnath — the 'Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta' (Setting the Wheel of Dharma in Motion).
- He passed into Parinirvana at Kushinagar at age 80.



Core Philosophy of Buddhism

The Four Noble Truths (Chatvari Aryasatyani)

- 1. Dukkha (Suffering):** All conditioned existence is characterized by suffering, dissatisfaction, and impermanence.
 - 2. Samudaya (Origin of Suffering):** Suffering arises from craving (tanha) — for sensual pleasure, existence, and annihilation.
 - 3. Nirodha (Cessation of Suffering):** Complete cessation of craving leads to Nirvana — the end of the cycle of rebirth.
 - 4. Magga (Path to Cessation):** The Noble Eightfold Path is the means to overcome craving and attain liberation.
- Three Marks of Existence: Anicca (impermanence), Dukkha (suffering), Anatta (no-self).
 - The Middle Way: Buddha rejected both extreme asceticism and sensual indulgence, advocating a balanced path.



The Eightfold Path

Ashtangika Marga — The Path to Nirvana

- Grouped into three categories: Wisdom, Ethical Conduct, and Mental Discipline.

WISDOM (Prajna):

1. Right View (Samma Ditthi): Understanding the Four Noble Truths.
2. Right Intention (Samma Sankappa): Commitment to renunciation, goodwill, and harmlessness.

ETHICAL CONDUCT (Sila):

3. Right Speech (Samma Vaca): Truthful, kind, helpful, and timely speech.
4. Right Action (Samma Kammanta): Non-killing, non-stealing, non-sexual misconduct.
5. Right Livelihood (Samma Ajiva): Avoiding occupations that harm living beings.

MENTAL DISCIPLINE (Samadhi):

6. Right Effort (Samma Vayama): Cultivating wholesome states of mind.
7. Right Mindfulness (Samma Sati): Awareness of body, feelings, mind, and mental objects.
8. Right Concentration (Samma Samadhi): Meditative absorption through the four Jhanas.



Sects of Buddhism

Hinayana, Mahayana & Vajrayana

Hinayana / Theravada ('Way of the Elders'):

- Emphasis on individual liberation through monastic discipline.
- Preserves the Pali Canon (Tripitaka) as the oldest authentic scripture.
- Predominant in Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Cambodia, and Laos.

Mahayana ('Great Vehicle'):

- Ideal of the Bodhisattva — one who delays personal nirvana to help all beings achieve liberation.
- Developed new texts: Prajnaparamita sutras, Lotus Sutra, Heart Sutra.
- Predominant in China, Japan, Korea, Vietnam, and Tibet.

Vajrayana ('Diamond/Thunderbolt Vehicle'):

- Tantric Buddhism; emphasizes rituals, mantras, mandalas, and esoteric practices.
- Centered in Tibet, Bhutan, Mongolia, and parts of Nepal.



Sacred Texts

Jain Agamas & Buddhist Tripitakas

JAIN SACRED TEXTS — The Agamas:

- 45 canonical texts preserved in the Ardhamagadhi Prakrit language.
- Compiled after Mahavira's death at the Council of Pataliputra (c. 300 BCE).
- Subdivided into Angas, Upangas, Mool Sutras, and others.
- Digambaras reject the Agamas; rely instead on texts like Shatkhandagama.

BUDDHIST SACRED TEXTS — The Tripitaka (Three Baskets):

1. Vinaya Pitaka: Rules governing the monastic community (sangha).
 2. Sutta Pitaka: Discourses (suttas) of the Buddha and his disciples.
 3. Abhidhamma Pitaka: Philosophical and psychological analysis of the Dharma.
- Preserved in Pali (Theravada), Sanskrit, Chinese, and Tibetan translations.



Art and Architecture

Stupas, Cave Temples & Colossal Statues

BUDDHIST ARCHITECTURE:

- Stupa: A hemispherical mound enshrining relics of the Buddha. The Great Stupa at Sanchi (3rd century BCE) is the oldest stone structure in India.
- Chaitya: A prayer hall with a stupa at the apse end. The Karla Caves (1st century BCE) house magnificent rock-cut chaityas.
- Vihara: Monastic complex for monks; Nalanda and Vikramshila were among the largest.
- The Ajanta Caves: 30 rock-cut caves with stunning Buddhist murals and sculptures (2nd century BCE – 6th century CE).

JAIN ARCHITECTURE:

- Dilwara Temples (Mount Abu, Rajasthan, 11th–13th century CE): Renowned for their incredibly intricate white marble carvings.
- Gomateshvara Statue (Shravanabelagola): A 57-foot monolithic granite statue of the Jain saint Bahubali, erected in 981 CE.
- Palitana Temples (Gujarat): A hilltop complex of 900+ Jain temples, considered one of the holiest pilgrimage sites in Jainism.



Geographical Spread Across Asia

From India to the Ends of the Known World

BUDDHISM — Missionary expansion driven by Emperor Ashoka (c. 268–232 BCE):

- Ashoka sent missionaries including his son Mahinda and daughter Sanghamitta to Sri Lanka.
- Buddhism spread along the Silk Road to Central Asia, China (1st century CE), Korea (4th century CE), and Japan (6th century CE).
- Southeast Asia received Theravada Buddhism via sea trade routes.
- Today, approximately 535 million Buddhists worldwide (7% of global population).

JAINISM — More geographically contained:

- Primarily practiced within India, with significant communities in Gujarat, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, and Karnataka.
- Diaspora communities in the UK, USA, Kenya, and Southeast Asia.
- Today, approximately 4–6 million Jains worldwide, mostly in India.



Similarities Between Both Religions

Shared Roots, Shared Values

- Both originated in the same region (northeastern India) and the same historical period (6th–5th century BCE).
- Both are non-theistic (do not believe in a creator God) and emphasize personal effort over divine grace.
- Both reject the authority of the Vedas and the supremacy of the Brahmin priesthood.
- Both accept the doctrines of karma (law of moral cause and effect) and samsara (cycle of rebirth).
- Both stress ahimsa (non-violence) as a foundational ethical principle.
- Both emphasize renunciation (sannyasa) and ascetic practice as the path to liberation.
- Both organized monastic communities (sangha / charturvidha sangha) as the backbone of the religion.
- Both produced rich traditions of philosophy, logic, art, and architecture.



Key Differences

Atheism, Asceticism, Soul, and Karma

SOUL (Atman):

- Jainism: Every living being possesses an eternal, individual soul (jiva) that is inherently pure and omniscient.
- Buddhism: Doctrine of Anatta (no-self) — no permanent, unchanging soul exists; selfhood is an illusion.

KARMA:

- Jainism: Karma is a subtle physical substance that literally attaches to the soul.
- Buddhism: Karma is a mental/moral force — an intention that produces consequences; purely non-physical.

ASCETICISM:

- Jainism: Advocates extreme asceticism; Digambara monks practice complete nudity and pull out their hair by the roots.
- Buddhism: Rejects extreme asceticism; the Middle Way (between self-indulgence and self-mortification) is the ideal.

GOD:

- Jainism: Tirthankaras are liberated human souls — perfect, omniscient, but not creators; no creator God.
- Buddhism: The Buddha is a teacher, not a god; early Buddhism is explicitly non-theistic.



Legacy and Impact on the Modern World

2,500 Years of Living Tradition

JAINISM'S MODERN IMPACT:

- Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of Satyagraha (non-violent resistance) was deeply inspired by Jain ahimsa.
- Environmental ethics: Jain teachings on respect for all life forms anticipate modern ecology and animal rights movements.
- Jain business communities (Marwaris, Gujaratis) played a pivotal role in India's trade and economic history.
- Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) offers a philosophical framework for pluralism and conflict resolution.

BUDDHISM'S MODERN IMPACT:

- Mindfulness-Based Stress Reduction (MBSR) and secular mindfulness movements draw directly from Buddhist meditation.
- The Dalai Lama's global advocacy for peace, human rights, and the environment reflects Buddhist values.
- Buddhist philosophy influenced Western psychology (Carl Jung), existentialism (Heidegger), and counterculture movements.
- UNESCO recognizes Buddhist sites (Bodh Gaya, Lumbini, Sanchi) as World Heritage Sites.

